



Plucking golden goose:

Sunrisers Hyderabad invested a scarcely believable Rs 20.5 crore in acquiring Australia's ODI World Cup and WTC-winning captain Pat Cummins. SPORTSPICS/IPL

slide him into a role. He fits in nicely," said fellow Kiwi and CSK head coach Stephen Fleming about Mitchell.

Harshal Patel: While he may have fallen off the national selectors' radar, Harshal continued to attract interest at the auction table. Although slated under the all-rounder tag, Harshal's expertise in bowling the middle and death overs places him in a rare bracket among Indian bowlers. Punjab Kings roped in Harshal for Rs 11.75 crore after fending off Lucknow Super Giants and Gujarat Titans.

Alzarri Joseph: In the auction's major surprise, West Indies seamer Alzarri Joseph landed a spectacular Rs 11.50 crore bid from RCB, with four other teams in contention to sign him. His figures of 6/12 — the best in IPL history — came on his debut four years ago. The Antiguan has only played 18 games since, taking 14 wickets. While he will

contribute with his hit-the-deck style at the Chinnaswamy Stadium in Bengaluru, Joseph's standing as a dependable choice remains uncertain.

Spencer Johnson: Fast on the rise in the Australian circuit, left-arm quick Johnson has only played 20 T20s. He was also taken for plenty in his solitary ODI appearance (0/61) against India in September. However, that did not deter a late surge for the 28-year-old, who landed his maiden IPL contract with GT at Rs 10 crore, 20 times his base price of Rs 50 lakh.

The catapults

The auction also threw in potentially life-changing deals for uncapped Indians. After impressive exploits in the state T20 league and age-group cricket, Uttar Pradesh batter Sameer Rizvi's CSK stocks increased from a Rs 20 lakh base price to Rs 8.40 crore. Following the Dhoni fad in Jharkhand,

wicket-keeper batters Kumar Kushagra (Rs 7.20 crore to DC) and Robin Minz (Rs 3.60 crore to GT) bagged headline-worthy deals. Shahrukh Khan (Rs 7.4 crore, GT), Shubham Dubey (Rs 5.80 crore, Rajasthan Royals), M. Siddharth (Rs 2.40 crore, LSG), Sushant Mishra (Rs 2.2 crore, GT) and Sumit Kumar (Rs 1 crore, DC) were the other overnight uncapped crorepatists.

Top spenders

Teams that entered the auction with the largest purses left the arena with the least baggage. KKR shelled out Rs 31.35 crore for 11 players, while SRH splashed out Rs 30.80 crore to sign Cummins, Travis Head, Wanindu Hasaranga, and backup bowlers.

CSK went all in to complete its quota of 25 players, spending Rs 30.4 crore. IPL 2023 runner-up GT used Rs 30.30 crore to add further variety in bowling and batting muscle.